



What Comes Next?

Quick facilitation notes & answer key

Goal

Children read a repeating pattern and identify the next element. Recognizing and continuing patterns is a foundational computational-thinking skill — it is how computers repeat a process the same way every time.

Kindergarten frame (Ontario)

Problem Solving and Innovating — children identify, reproduce, and extend repeating patterns.

No reading required of the child: read each prompt aloud; the child draws the next shape.

Materials

The printed worksheet + a pencil/crayon. Optional: pattern blocks or beads to build the pattern by hand first.

Run it (about 15 min)

1. MODEL: point and say the pattern aloud — 'triangle, square, triangle, square...'. The next is a square.
2. GUIDED: do Exercise 1 together — read • ★ • ★ • aloud, the next is ★.
3. YOU TRY: children do Exercise 2 (next is ■), then Exercise 3, the two-then-one pattern (next is ★).
4. Connect: 'Computers follow patterns too — that is how they repeat a job exactly the same way.'

Answer key (modelled by the run-gate)

Model — ▲ ■ ▲ ■ ▲ → next is ■.

Ex 1 — • ★ • ★ • → next is ★. Ex 2 — ■ ▲ ■ ▲ → next is ■.

Ex 3 — ★ ★ • ★ ★ • → next is ★ (the pattern is star, star, circle, repeating).

Watch for & differentiate

Common slip: copying the last shape shown — have them say the whole pattern aloud first.

Simplify: build the pattern with real blocks and add the next one by hand.

Extend: ask the child to keep the pattern going for two or three more shapes.

Movement option: clap–stomp–clap–stomp and ask what action comes next.

Success looks like

The child says the repeating unit aloud and draws the correct next shape for each pattern.